spirits outside space and time) and Primal Matter (*Pradhana* or *Mula Prakriti*) that transforms itself (***parinama***) into the cosmos of mental and material phenomena. They accept the ***satkaryavada*** theory of causation which holds that products pre-exist in a potential form in their underlying, material causes. Prime Matter consists of three strands or qualities (***guna***): *sattva* (goodness and light), *rajas* (dynamic energy) and *tamas* (heavy and dark). Before the cosmic transformation, they are in a state of equilibrium, cancelling out one another's properties. The *Purushas* are inactive, individual centres of unchanging self-awareness. Their 'mere existence' is said to prompt the transformation of material nature. *Prakriti* transforms for the sake of the human souls so that they have experiences that lead them to realise the difference between soul and matter. Opponents ask how an unconscious cause can act for the sake of anything, let alone produce specific and organised realities.

Matter evolves to produce the basic material and psychological realities (***tattva – buddhi*** (mind); ***ahamkara*** (ego and will); ***manas*** (sensory coordinator); the five senses (***indriya***), physical organs; the essences of sounds, touch, colours, tastes and smells; and the gross elements – space, air, fire, water and earth which make up physical objects). These products contain the ***gunas*** in differing proportions.

The *Purushas* become entangled in and misidentify themselves with aspects of the material environment, in particular psychological faculties and body. Given the 'proximity' of the *Purusha*-consciousness to the mind (***buddhi***), the latter is illuminated (the material ***buddhi*** becomes 'consciousness-like') and the confusion is compounded when the activity of the ***buddhi*** is misattributed to the inactive *Purusha*. Thus we have the origins of the individual person and the series of births marked